ISO 37000

Checklist

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ISO 37000 provides guidance on how to implement governance practices within an organisation. Published in September 2021, ISO 37000 constitutes an international consensus on what society defines as good governance since it was developed and approved by members from 77 countries.

ISO 37000 defines governance as a human-based system by which an organisation is directed, overseen and held accountable for achieving its defined organisational purpose. In this checklist, we provide a simplified approach to following the guidance issued by this standard.

Step 1:

Define or confirm the organisation's purpose

Methods for determining purpose include:

- reviewing the annual report, code of conduct and other governing documents to check if an organisational purpose has been clearly defined by stakeholders, management and the governing body
- checking if the organisation's purpose is driven by a set of core values
- communicating the organisational purpose and associated values to employees, third parties, customers and the general public.

Step 2:

Determine the organisation's approach to value generation

The focus for all organisations should be to fulfil their organisational purpose by generating value over time. To achieve this, organisations need to generate value that represents something of worth to their stakeholders.

To design or confirm a value-generation model, organisations should:

- define value-generation objectives
- set parameters around value generation, such as balancing value versus potential impacts and defining resources for value generation
- deliver and sustain value to stakeholders over time.

Step 3:

Develop an organisational strategy for generating value and achieving purpose

A strategy provides direction for guiding efforts towards the organisational purpose and associated value-generation objectives.

The organisational strategy should:

- establish governance policies to outline strategy, guide delegations, define risk management and address continual improvement
- steer the organisational strategy through company culture, sustainable business practices, realistic KPIs and targets, and by monitoring performance.

Step 4:

Conduct oversight

Oversight ensures that value generation and strategy are achieving the organisational purpose.

Proper oversight includes:

- checking that delegations to management and personnel are being carried out faithfully and effectively
- monitoring policies to ensure they drive desired behaviour and actions
- reviewing reports and performance metrics to confirm the organisation is meeting stakeholder expectations
- reviewing risk management and compliance information to manage threats and opportunities and preserve integrity
- managing stakeholder feedback and expectations
- attaining assurance (either internally or provided by external partners) regarding the effectiveness of the governance system.

Step 5:

Establish accountability for the governance system

The governing body must be held accountable for the performance of the governance system it has established.

Accountability can be demonstrated through:

- reporting on organisational performance against key goals

- publicising information about the governing body and any changes to its makeup
- seeking feedback from and responding to stakeholders.

Step 6:

Engage with stakeholders

Stakeholders are a key aspect in shaping, managing and delivering on the organisational purpose.

To engage with stakeholders effectively, organisations should:

- identify and prioritise stakeholders
- ensure organisational culture is responsive to relevant stakeholder views
- maintain and develop relationships with stakeholders
- respect human and labour rights in all countries of operation
- ensure reporting is accessible by stakeholders so they can understand the governance system, values and key protocols.

Step 7:

Adopt key practices to promote the governance system

These key practices include:

- effective and ethical leadership
- the responsible use of data for decision-making
- maintaining risk management and compliance programmes
- promoting social responsibility, to drive sustainable development
- ensuring organisational viability over the long term.

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Scott Lane is the CEO and founder of Speeki. With a background in law and technology, he has combined legal expertise with innovative solutions to become a leading authority in ESG, sustainability, governance, assurance, anti-corruption and compliance. Backed by decades of experience, Scott has consulted for thousands of clients across more than 100 countries. His extensive work in governance and compliance has shaped corporate strategies worldwide, making him a trusted voice in the field.

About Speeki

Speeki enables companies to build, manage, report on and assure ESG and sustainability initiatives, transforming ESG challenges into business opportunities with AI-driven software and solutions.

With our all-in-one Speeki® platform, we help companies seamlessly manage their ESG and sustainability programmes, strengthen corporate sustainability due diligence in line with directives like the CSDDD, and streamline reporting according to standards and frameworks such as GRI, ESRS, IFRS (S1 and S2) and more.

More than just software, Speeki provides ESG assurance and ISO certifications covering over 20 ESG and sustainability topics.

Our mission is to build a more sustainable world by helping companies achieve their sustainability goals, meet regulatory requirements and address stakeholder expectations, driving long-term value at every stage of their ESG journey.

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